

David Bloom

The Disillusioned Eddie Sawyer
Mauch's A Feisty Sort Of Guy
Minoso And The Fortunate Trades

ATLANTA, April 23.—The divorce of Eddie Sawyer from the Phillies was shocking to a great many people only because of its abruptness . . . Nobody expects a manager to resign the day before the season opens, regardless of the chances of his club . . . but



Sawyer

troubled.

Sawyer presented a picture of pure gloom in the Clearwater camp . . . On this day the Phils were playing the Pirates and he said to an aide, "Ask Danny Murtaugh (Pirate manager) if he wants to borrow any of my ball players . . . I've got 33, ha, ha" . . . He was disappointed over the showing of his second baseman, George Anderson, had been critical of the veteran infielder Ted Lepcio and some infractions of training rules had him severely

So Sawyer quit, saying "I just don't want to be a major league manager" . . . And Andy Cohen, the man who for 35 years really wanted to be one and never quite got there, was named . . . for one day . . . Cohen, real good in the minors (including the Southern), said for many a year that this was his one ambition in life . . . No major-league team considered the round little fellow seriously, including the Phils . . . He beat the Braves in his lone outing and immediately yielded to Gene Mauch, picked as Sawyer's successor the day of the resignation . . . And Andrew is still on the outside looking in.

A Weird, Winning Move

Mauch is a controversial character, a sort of a modified fire eater, maybe a little of the Charlie Dressen type . . . He managed Atlanta in the Southern in 1953, the year Luke Appling won the pennant with the Chicks, and he figured in a widely discussed incident . . . The Chicks were leading in the second game of a doubleheader at Atlanta very late in the afternoon . . . They had but to get the Crackers out in the last of the fifth to win the game . . . Mauch, disagreeing with the umpires, decided it was too dark to play . . . and proceeded to sit on the plate to keep the Memphis pitcher from throwing . . . There was much milling around by the umpires and both teams, but instead of forfeiting the game, the umpires yielded to Mauch and called it . . . In a stormy hearing in Atlanta, Charlie Hurth, then president of the league, yielded to the Cracker arguments and initiated a suspended-game rule . . . It wasn't satisfactory then and it still isn't.

Kerby Farrell, who manages the Buffalo team in the International League, a Phillies farm, must have been disappointed that he didn't get the call to the parent club . . . But, if things go well, Kerby probably will be handling the Buffalo entry in the new Continental League . . . Speaking of former minor-league managers, Whit Wyatt says he loves his work as pitching coach of the Braves . . . and "I don't have to do much coaching" . . . Not with the staff Milwaukee has.